6. The discussion here is meant to give a qualitative sense of how an experience right *now,* together with memories that you have right *now,* forms the basis of your sense of having experienced a life in which you've lived out those memories. But, if, for example, your brain and body were somehow put into exactly the same state that they are right now, you would have the same sense of having lived the life that your memories attest to (assuming, as I do, that the basis of all experience can be found in the physical state of brain and body), even if those experiences never really happened, but were artificially imprinted into your brain state. One simplification in the discussion is the assumption that we can feel or experience things that happen at a single instant, when, in reality, processing time is required for the brain to recognize and interpret whatever stimuli it receives. While true, this is not of particular relevance to the point I'm making; it is an interesting but largely irrelevant complication arising from analyzing time in a manner directly tied to human experience. As we discussed earlier, human examples help make our discussion more grounded and visceral, but it does require us to tease out those aspects of the discussion that are more interesting from a biological as opposed to a physical perspective.

7. You might wonder how the discussion in this chapter relates to our description in Chapter 3 of objects "moving" through spacetime at the speed of light. For the mathematically disinclined reader, the rough answer is that the history of an object is represented by a curve in spacetime—a path through the spacetime loaf that highlights every place the object has been at the moment it was there (much as we see in Figure 5.1). The intuitive notion of "moving" through spacetime, then, can be expressed in "flowless" language by simply specifying this path (as opposed to imagining the path being traced out before your eyes). The "speed" associated with this path is then a measure of how long the path is (from one chosen point to another), divided by the time difference recorded on a watch carried by someone or something between the two chosen points on the path. This, again, is a conception that does not involve any time flow: you simply look at what the watch in question says at the two points of interest. It turns out that the speed found in this way, for *any* motion, is equal to the speed of light. The mathematically inclined reader will realize that the reason for this is immediate. In Minkowski spacetime the metric is $ds^2 = c^2dt^2 - dx^2$ (where dx^2 is the